CREATURE LORE (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

"What does my character know about this creature?" With the **Study** action, an **Intelligence** check lets you recall an important piece of information, and each lore skill is tied to certain **creature types**. The SRD sets neither a DC nor a number of facts: this sheet offers a **table system**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You take the **Study** action: an **Intelligence** check (Arcana, History, Nature, or Religion by creature type).
2. The roll is **hidden**: its total gives a confidence level. Table rule
3. Add the bonuses, then compare the total to the DC, **raised by the creature's CR**. Table rule
4. The higher the total, the more **traits** you know. Table rule
5. Traits are rolled on a **d12** and described in natural language. Table rule

Example: Mira (History +5) studies a troll (Giant, CR 5). She rolls 15 + 5 = 20: she feels "fairly confident" and knows the name and 2 traits (How to play page).

⚠ What the SRD says:

- **Study**: an Intelligence check to recall an important piece of information.
- Each lore skill is tied to certain **creature types** (Tables page).

⚠ What is a table rule: Table rule

- The hidden roll and the confidence levels.
- The DC raised by CR and the information table.
- The d12 trait table and the possible second skill.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say what to reveal or at what DC, and players can turn it into metagaming. Fix: the table system, with a **hidden roll**.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

Speak in natural language, without numbers: a creature "faster than a riding horse," "as nimble as your 90-year-old grandmother," a "deadly foe," or a "trivial pest."

Step 1 – Choose who can test: Table rule

Characters with the right skill or strong ties to the creature. For a small group, everyone can test, or the base DC goes up.

Step 2 – Take the Study action:

You make an **Intelligence** check. The skill depends on the creature type (Tables page).

Step 3 – Roll in secret: Table rule

The roll is made behind the screen, hidden from the player. The DM whispers the confidence level from the total. Bonuses added afterward (Help, Inspiration...) count before any information is revealed:

- **10 or less**: "You're not sure of your knowledge."
- **11 to 20**: "You feel fairly confident."
- **Over 20**: "You feel very confident."

Step 4 – Compare to the DC: Table rule

Add the creature's **CR** to each threshold (nothing below CR 1). A well-known creature (troll, werewolf) grants **Advantage**.

Total	What you know
under 5	one false trait
5	one defining trait, 50% chance of being false
10	one distinctive trait
15	the name + 2 traits
20	the name + 3 traits
25	the name + 4 traits
30	the name + 5 traits

Example: Mira (History +5) studies a troll (CR 5, thresholds +5), with Advantage. She rolls 9 and 15: she keeps 15, total 20 ("fairly confident"), so "the name + 2 traits" (threshold 15 + 5). On the d12: 5 ("very sturdy") and 10 ("fears fire").

Step 5 – Reveal the traits: Table rule

Roll traits on the d12 (Tables page), in natural language. Duplicate: reroll.

Skill by creature type:

Type	SRD	Table option Table rule
Aberration	Arcana	–
Beast	Nature	–
Celestial	Religion	+ Arcana
Construct	Arcana	–
Dragon	Nature	+ Arcana, History
Elemental	Arcana	–
Fey	Arcana	+ Nature
Fiend	Religion	+ Arcana
Giant	History	+ Nature
Humanoid	History	–
Monstrosity	Arcana	+ Nature
Ooze	Nature	–
Plant	Nature	–
Undead	Religion	+ Arcana

Trait table (d12): Table rule

d12	Trait revealed
1	An ability or a trait
2	The creature type
3	The Challenge Rating (CR)
4	The speed
5	A high ability score
6	A low ability score
7	A resistance
8	An immunity (damage or conditions)
9	An important historical fact
10	A vulnerability or other weakness
11	A special attack
12	The usual alignment

If the roll is a duplicate that teaches nothing new, reroll.

Common table questions.

Does recalling something take an action?

Yes: **Study** is an action, which matters mostly in combat.

Which skill if several fit?

The SRD skill for that type. With the table option, the player may also pick the second. Table rule

When do I add a bonus to the roll?

After the confidence whisper, but before any information is revealed. Table rule

Why hide the roll?

To avoid metagaming: a low result can give a false trait without the player knowing. Table rule

When to grant Advantage?

For a creature often met or part of popular lore (troll, werewolf). Table rule

Do we tell players the numbers?

No: use natural language ("faster than a riding horse"). Table rule

What about a duplicate on the trait table?

Reroll the d12 if it teaches nothing new. Table rule

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

20 and 1 on a check

On an ability check, a 20 or a 1 has no special effect: no Critical Hit, no automatic failure.

Telling if an effect is magical

The game text says whether an effect is magical. Effects from spells and magic items always are.

Notices: This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2.1 ("SRD 5.2.1") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2.1 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode. Unofficial sheet, 5E compatible (2024 rules), neither approved nor sponsored by Wizards of the Coast. Rules come from SRD 5.2.1; where the SRD gives no answer, explanations rely on our own interpretation. The "Table rule" parts are the author's own creations. Borders, banner, texture, titles, layout, table rules and examples: © Jaja, all rights reserved. Sources: SRD 5.2.1 (official English version); rule clarifications cross-checked with answers found on the web and reworded; numeric examples are invented; last revised: November 2026. Fonts: TeX Gyre Pagella (GUST), DejaVu Sans, Noto Color Emoji (OFL).